



SORBS

EUROPEAN RESIDENTS FROM BEFORE THE ROMAN CONQUEST

IN BRANDENBURG AND SAXONY, not far from the German borders with Poland and the Czech Republic, live 150,000 people who regard themselves not as German, but as Sorbian. Descendants of the Slavic tribes that dominated central Europe before the arrival of the Romans, they are not related to the Serbs of today. The Sorbs have their own Slavonic language, and around 60,000 people not only speak it, but also perform plays, broadcast on television and radio, publish newspapers, magazines, and books, and teach it in schools, too. The traditions of the 15,000 Sorbian Catholics are particularly strong. One of the best preserved is the Easter Riding in which processions of mounted locals visit nearby villages in traditional costumes to announce the resurrection of Jesus in song.

